



As soon as tiny seed pods begin to appear, pinch out the plants' growing tips—this encourages the plant to channel its energy into developing pods, and will also help to discourage attack from black bean aphid.

HARVESTING

Young pods can be cooked and eaten whole, but the fava beans themselves are ready to harvest in about three to four months, once they can be felt through their pods. Harvest from the bottom of the plant first. Do not leave them on the plant too long or they will become tough.

PESTS AND DISEASES

Use netting if attacks from birds and mice are particularly bad, and spray with a pyrethroid insecticide before the plant flowers to deter black bean aphids. Broadbean weevils may also be a problem and will damage pods.



Black bean aphids distort leaves.